

EPP confirms position on weakening ETS

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By Ben Makuch · Jul 16, 2026, 1:22 PM · [View in your browser](#)

The center-right European People's Party will push for a longer timeline for EU industry to decarbonize under a review of the EU Emissions Trading System.

In its most up-to-date position on the ETS review, seen by POLITICO, the EPP calls for the "linear reduction factor" — the rate at which the overall emissions cap is reduced each year — to be reduced by "at least" 1 percent until 2035.

After that it should take an "even more moderate trajectory," the paper said.

The paper itself is a more refined version of another draft of the EPP ETS position obtained by POLITICO in June, which was at the time still being edited within the party. Some key differences include more specific language around the allowance of international credits into the carbon pricing regime while protecting against divestments from Europe.

But the largest party in European Parliament is still clear about providing more free emissions allowances to industry and for longer. In an identical point from June, the EPP wants sectors falling under the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism — the bloc's border levy — to continue to receive more free allowances past 2034 if those sectors are lagging.

It also says any proposal to bring waste incineration under the ETS should "only be gradual" and opposes extending the EU's internal carbon price to flights out of the EU "unless a smart solution can be found to improve the competitiveness of European regions, airlines, and airports."

EPP lawmaker Peter Liese, who was appointed by the party to lead work on the ETS review in Parliament, told colleagues in an email that he hopes to bring "the Commission proposal as close as possible to the EPP position and will defend our priorities over the whole process."

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